

Windows Server

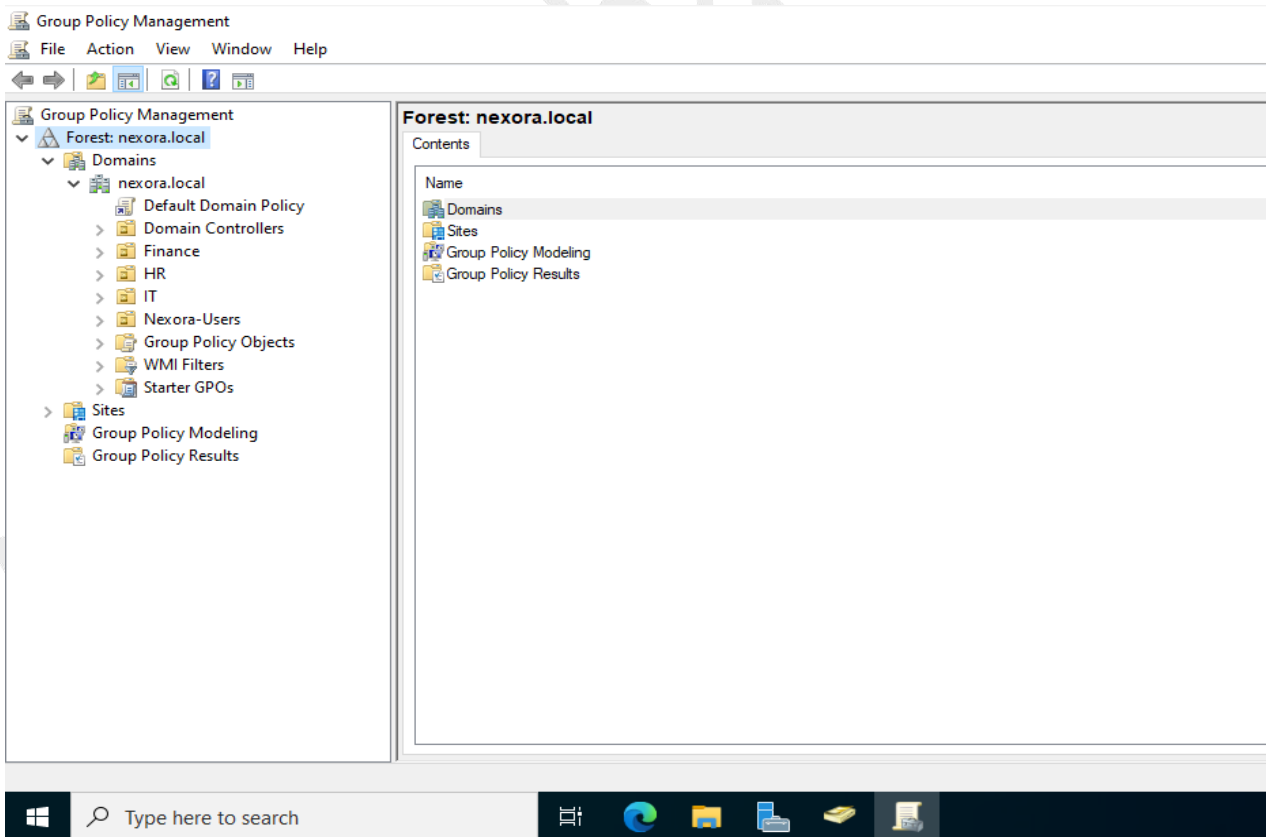
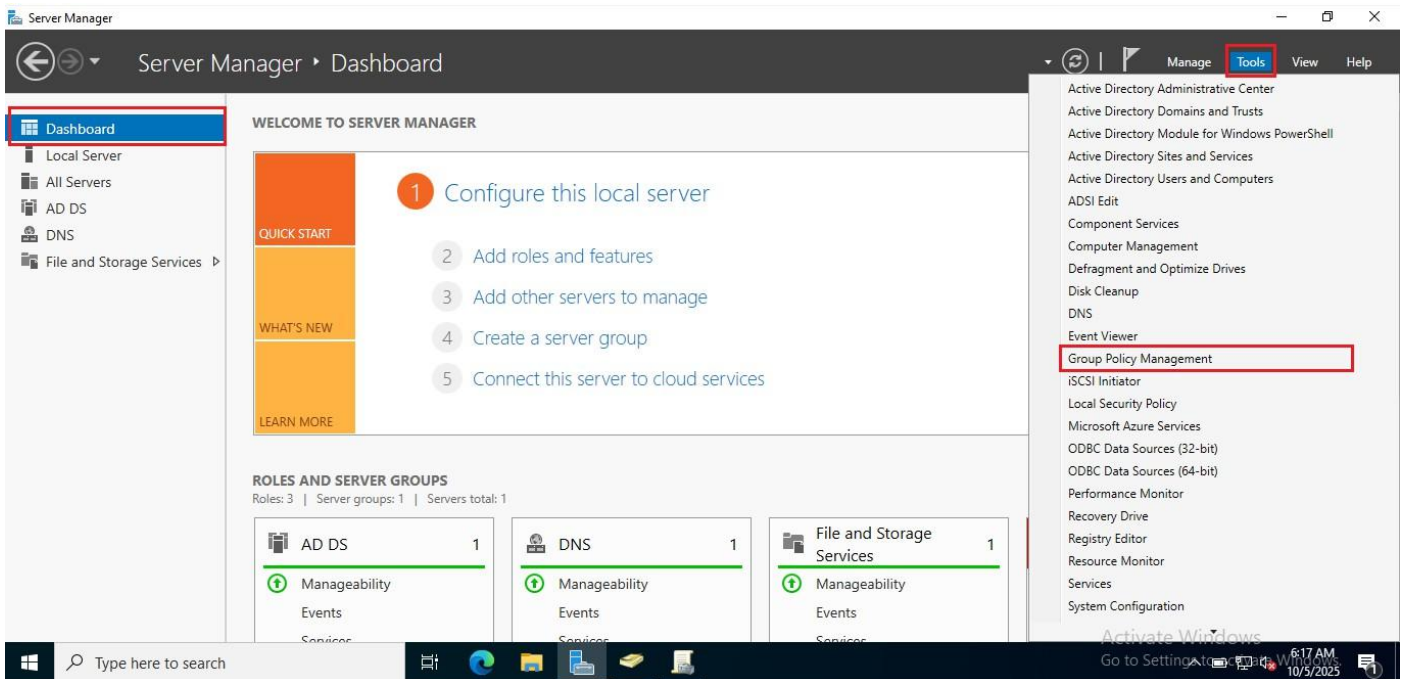
Active Directory – Group Policy Configuration and Testing

Step-by-step guide to
creating and testing
Group Policies in
Active Directory

- **Steps to Create GPO (Group Policy Object) :**

1. Open **Group Policy Management Console (GPMC)**

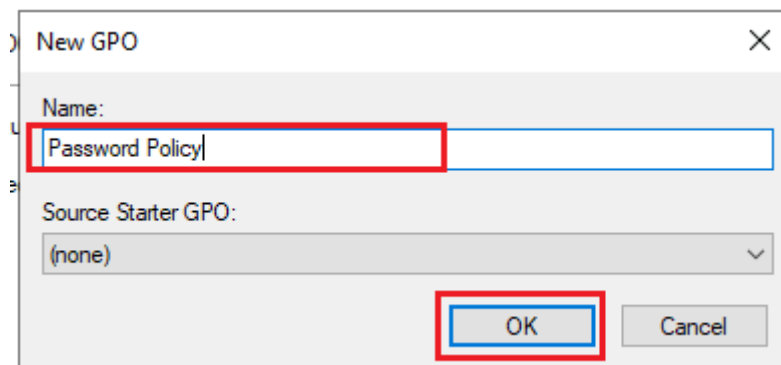
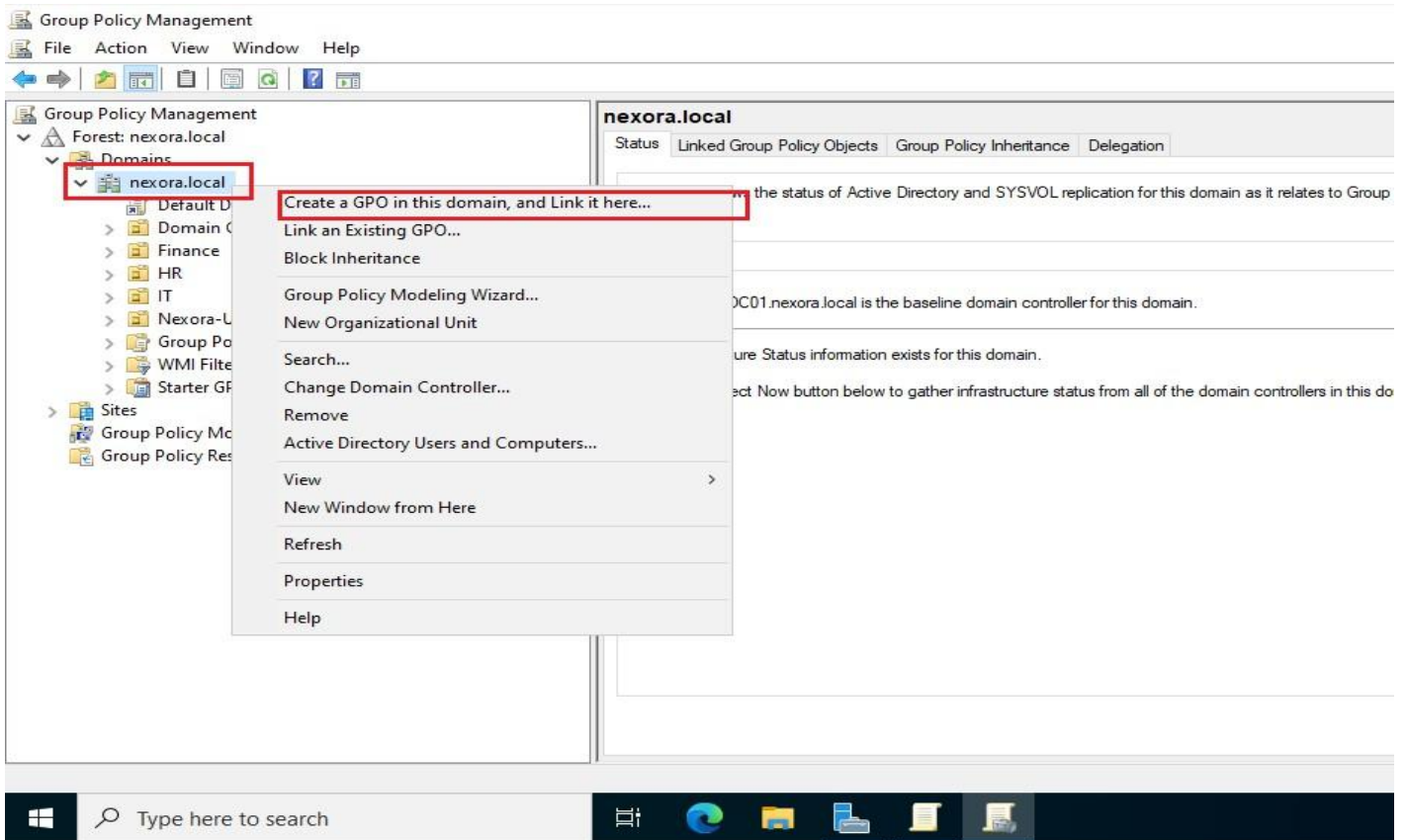
- Go to **Server Manager** → **Tools** → **Group Policy Management**
- Expand your forest (**nexora.local**) and domain.



2. Create a New **GPO**

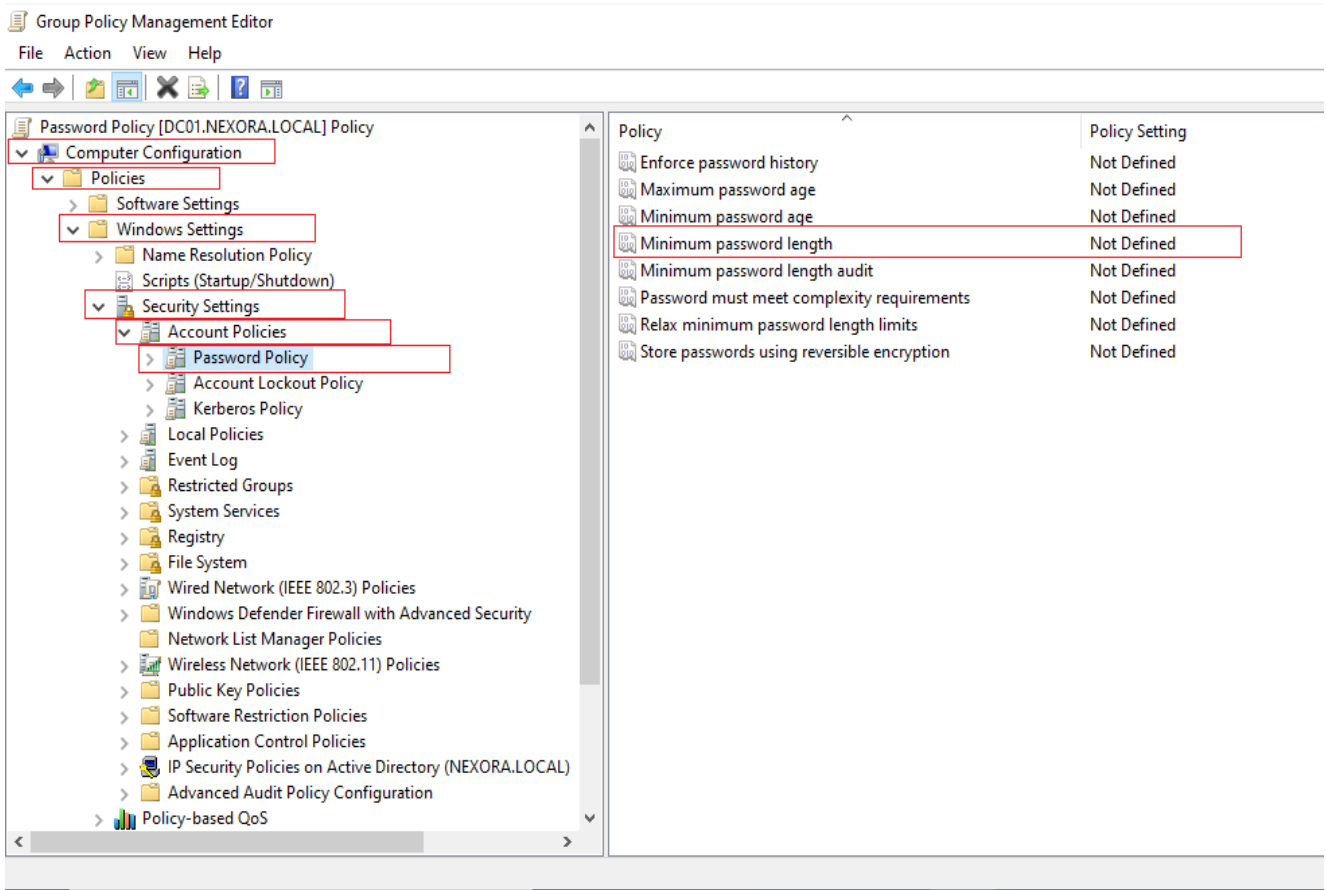
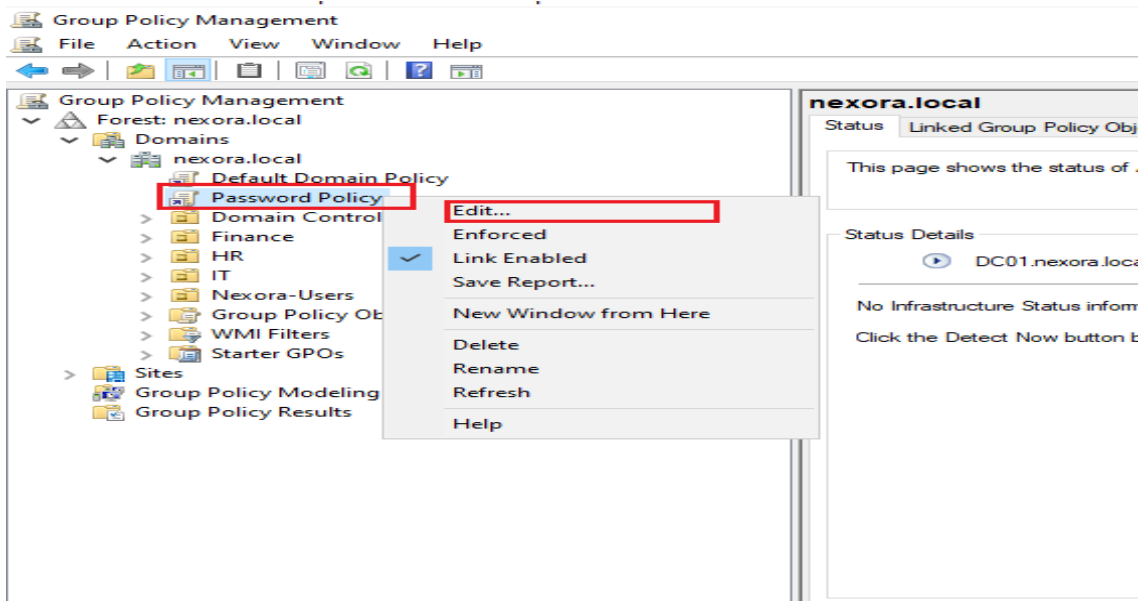
- Right-click on the OU/domain → **Create a GPO in this domain, and Link it here...**

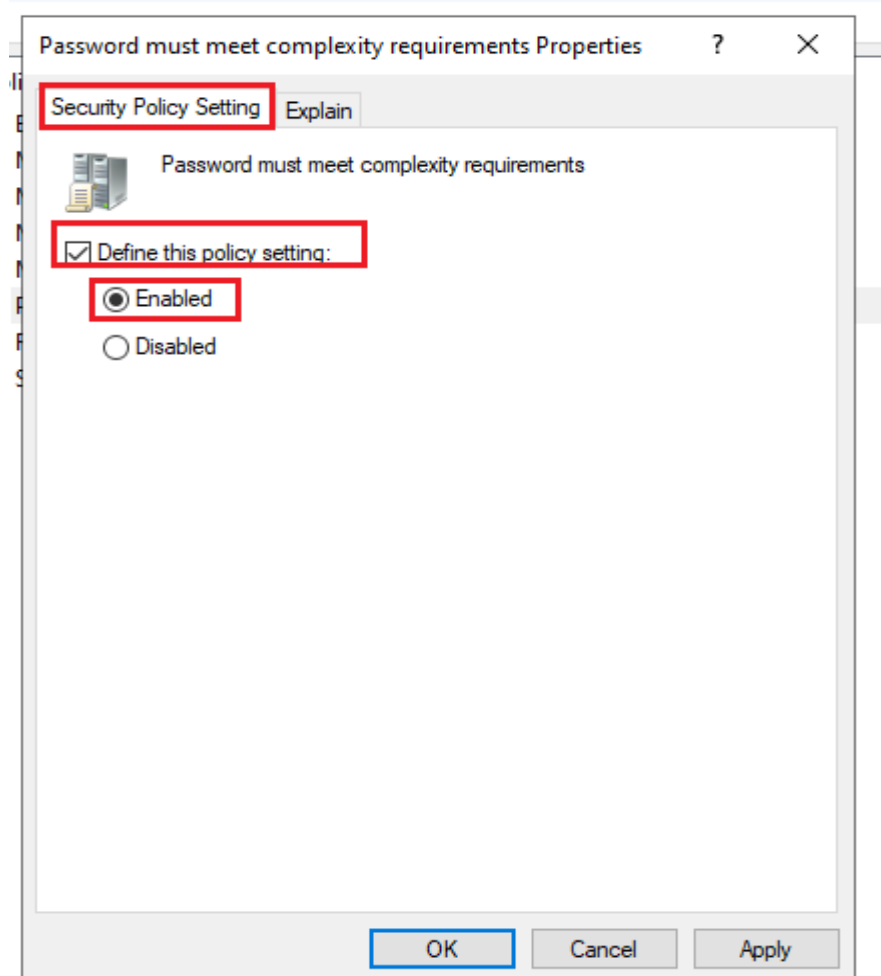
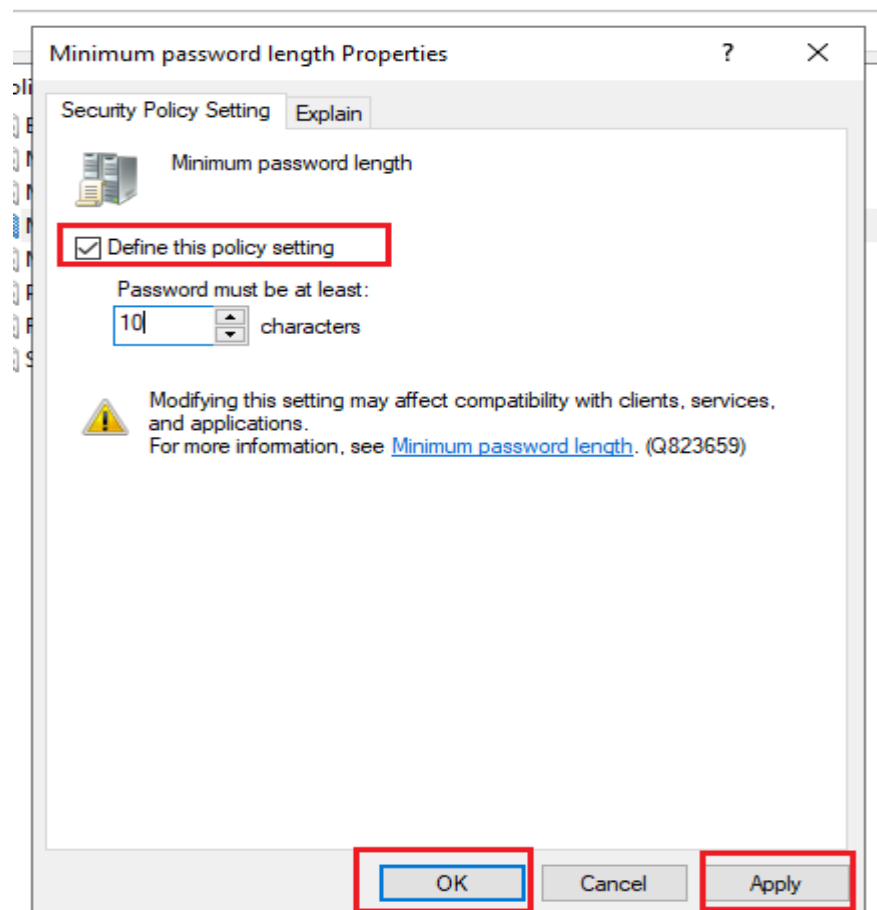
- Give it a name (e.g., "Password policy")

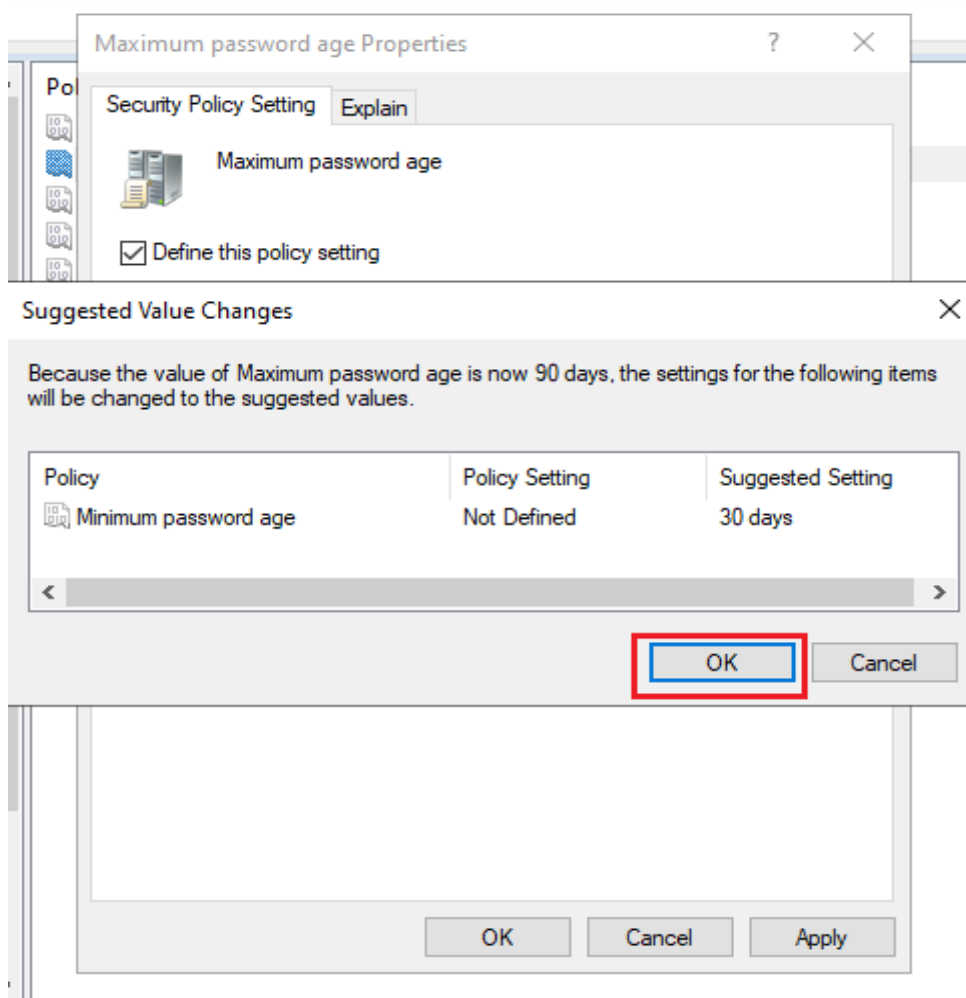
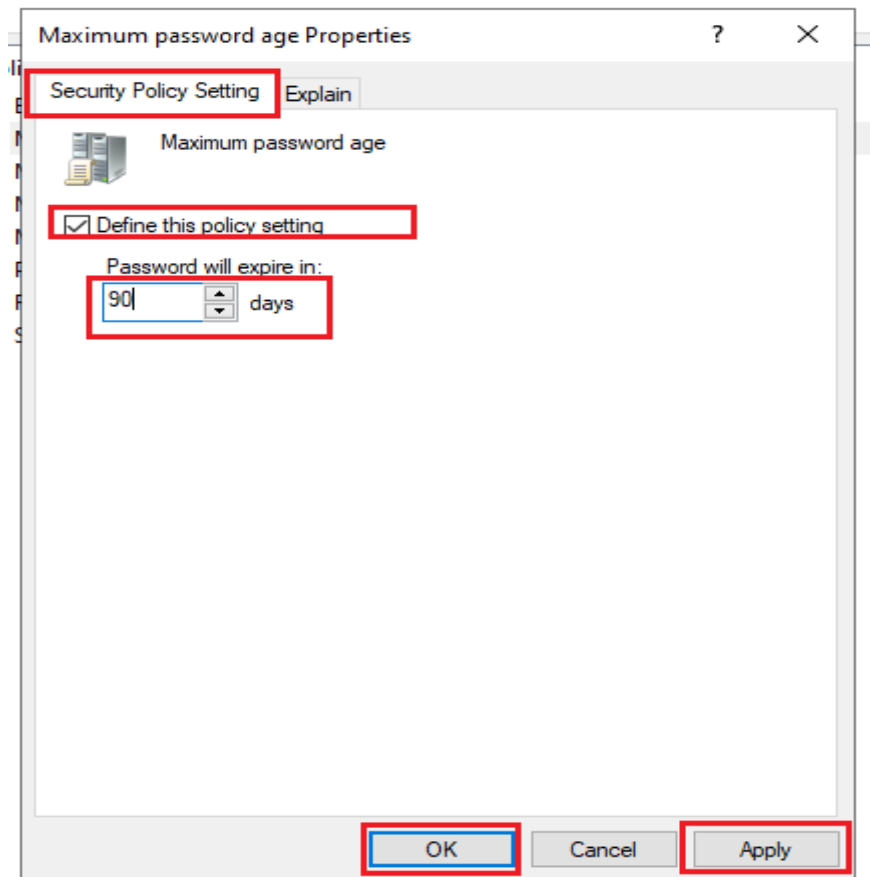


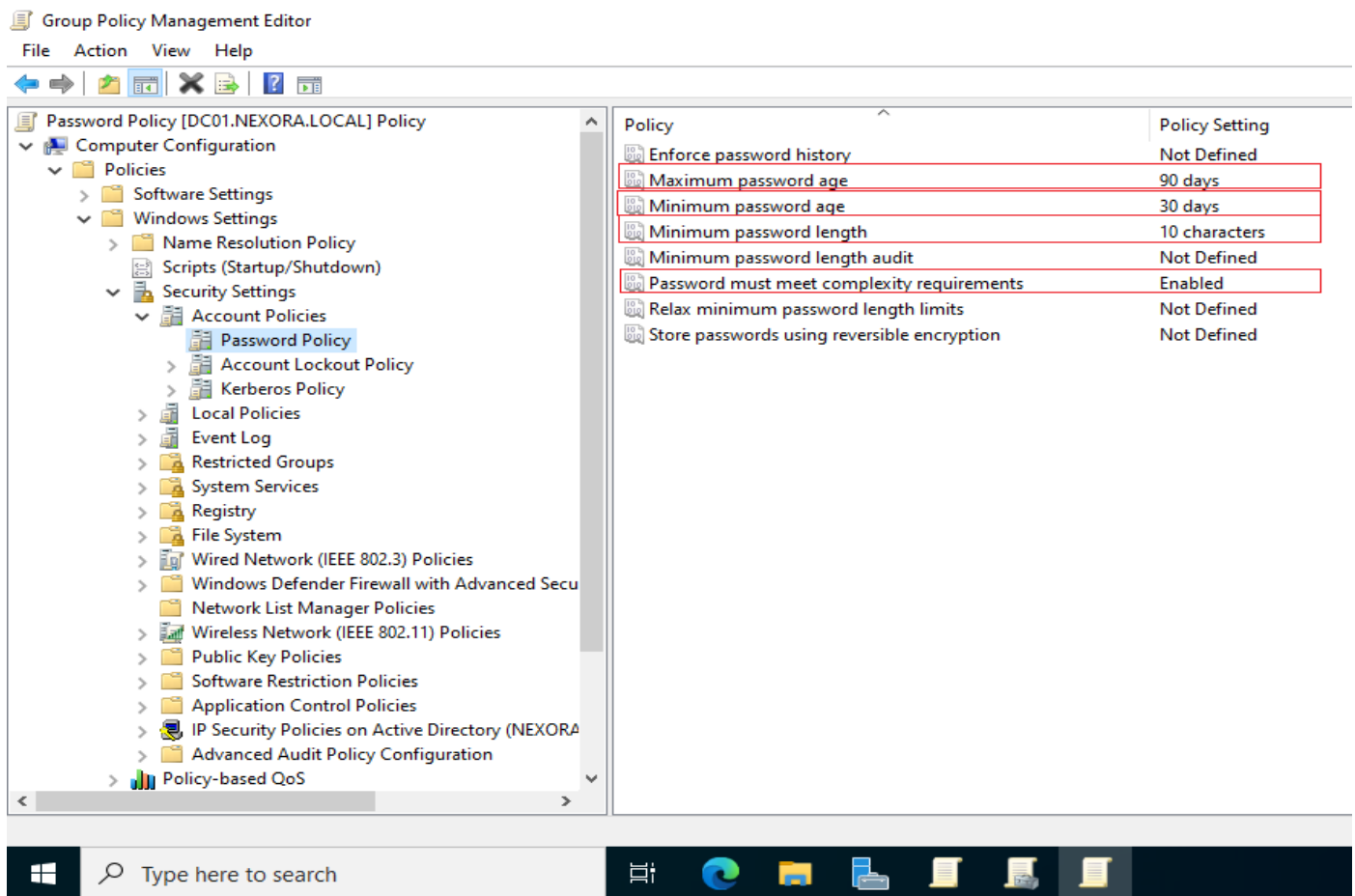
3. Edit the GPO

- Right-click your new GPO → **Edit**
- Choose your configuration type:
 - 1. If the policy targets computers** (e.g., password/account policies):
 - Navigate:
Computer Configuration → Policies → Windows Settings → Security Settings → Account Policies → Password Policy
 - **Important:** Domain password policies normally must be set at the **domain level** (Default Domain Policy) to affect all domain accounts. For per-user password rules use **Fine-Grained Password Policies (PSOs)** in AD.









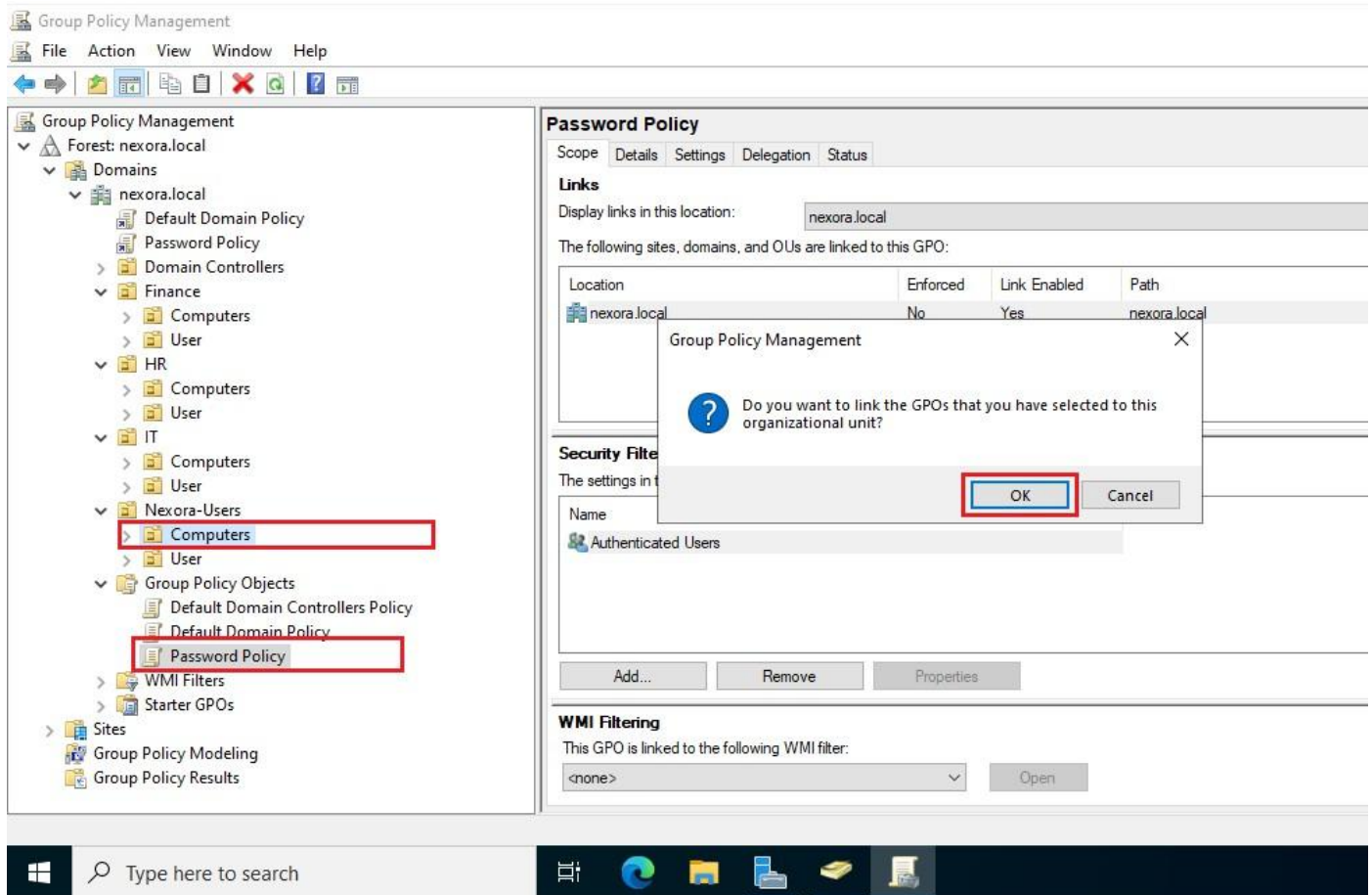
4. Link a **GPO** to an **OU**

Method 1 – Right-Click Method

1. Open **Group Policy Management** (gpmc.msc).
2. Expand your domain (**nexora.local**) and locate the **OU** (e.g., TestUsers or Workstations).
3. **Right-click** the OU → **Link an Existing GPO...**
4. From the list, select your GPO (e.g., “Password Policy”) → **OK**
 - ◆ The GPO now appears under that OU in the right-hand pane.

Method 2 – Drag and Drop Method

1. In **Group Policy Management**, expand **Group Policy Objects**.
2. Click and **drag** your GPO (e.g., “Password Policy”) onto the target OU (e.g., Users).
3. Drop it — you’ll see the GPO linked instantly.

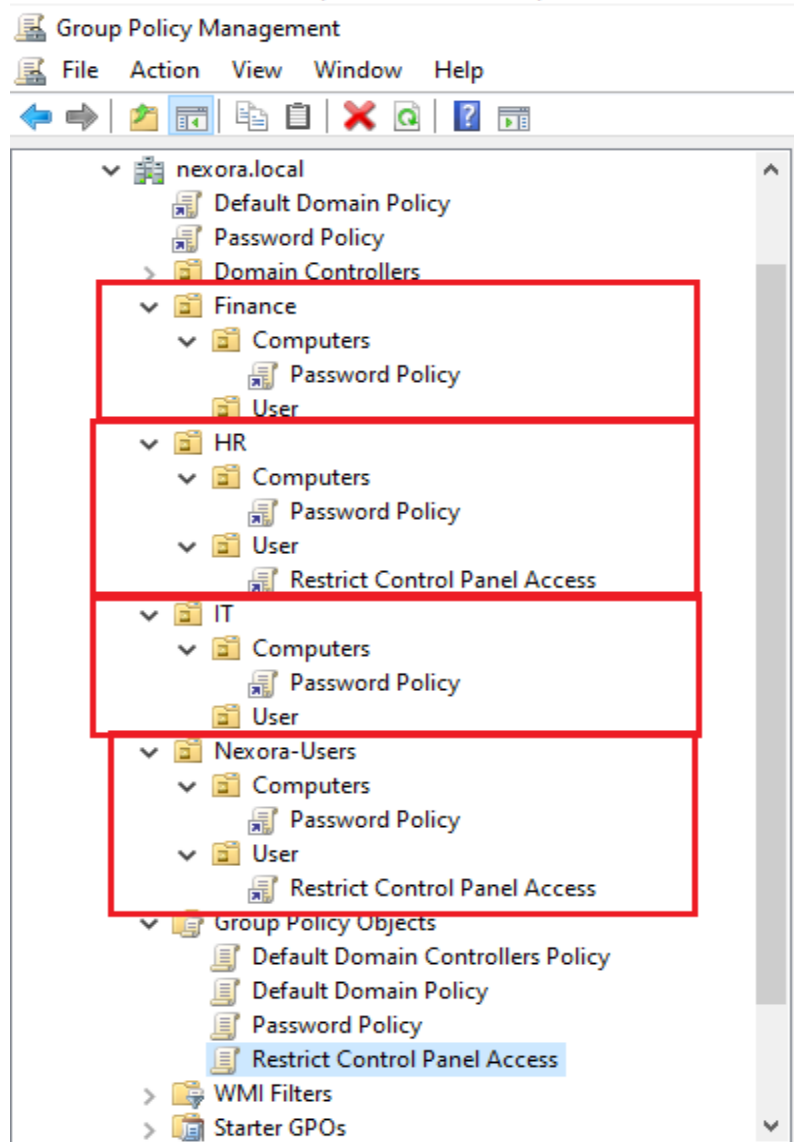


Now that we have already covered the detailed steps for **creating and linking a GPO** (in the previous section: *Password Policy*), we will follow the **same procedure** to create a new GPO for **User Configuration settings**.

Only the **policy path and configurations** will differ, as shown below.

5. Create a New GPO:

- Name: **Restrict Control Panel Access**
(Steps same as before: Create GPO → Link to OU → Edit)



6. Apply and Verify:

- On client machine, run gpupdate /force

```

C:\> Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19045.3803]
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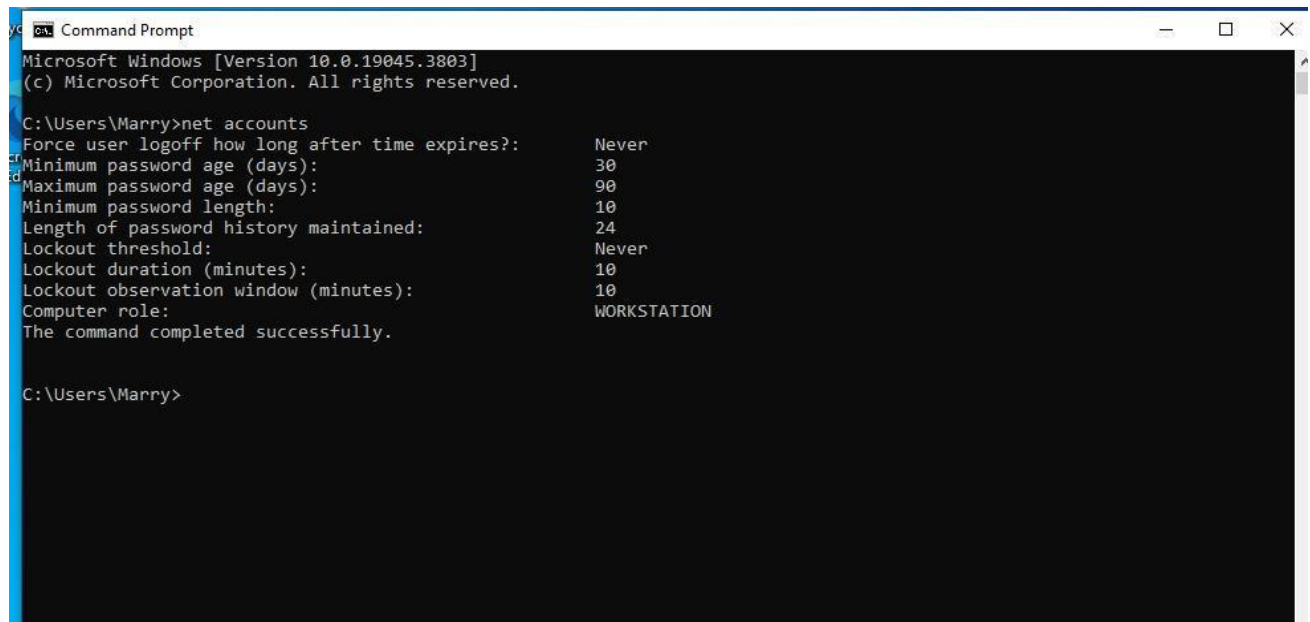
C:\Users\Marry>gpupdate /force
Updating policy...

Computer Policy update has completed successfully.
User Policy update has completed successfully.
  
```

- On the Client Machine (Domain-Joined):**
 - Open **Command Prompt** → Run: **net accounts** (Password Policy verification using the net accounts command.)
 - Check the displayed values such as:
 - Minimum password length
 - Maximum password age

- Password complexity requirements

(These should match the settings configured in your “Password Policy” GPO.)



```
Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19045.3803]
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C:\Users\Marry>net accounts
Force user logoff how long after time expires?: Never
Minimum password age (days): 30
Maximum password age (days): 90
Minimum password length: 10
Length of password history maintained: 24
Lockout threshold: Never
Lockout duration (minutes): 10
Lockout observation window (minutes): 10
Computer role: WORKSTATION
The command completed successfully.

C:\Users\Marry>
```

- Try to open Control Panel — access should be restricted A

